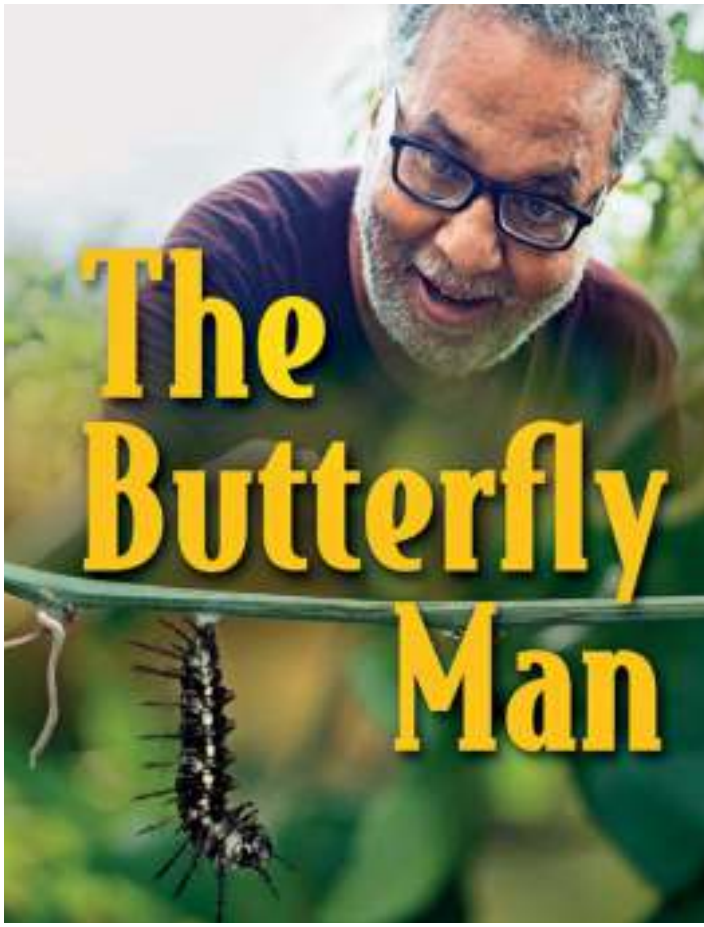
NATURE ▼

Chasing Wings

A new documentary puts the spotlight on the remarkable life and work of Isaac Kehimkar, the 'Butterfly Man of India'



Poster of *The Butterfly Man*; (right) Kehimkar's definitive field guide, *Butterflies of India*

The Dutch documentary filmmakers Sem Jones and Dennis Van Ooijen were busy filming in Maharashtra last year. Their documentary, *The Butterfly Man of India*, which is almost ready to hit the festival circuit now, centres around Isaac David Kehimkar, one of the country's premier experts on lepidoptera, especially butterflies. After a lot of to and fro online, the duo landed in Mumbai and headed to the hills of Karjat where he lives. "The film is about me and the butterflies, and me using butterflies to make people fall in love with nature," says Kehimkar. What was special, he observes, was that they had him record his commentary in Marathi and have used it as is with English subtitles.

Growing up in a cottage in Govandi, a suburb of Mumbai, in a time before TV or the internet had taken over people's lives, Kehimkar had a childhood rich in pets, and plenty of pictorial books on American birds and African animals. When his dad gifted him a camera in the eighth grade, Kehimkar started clicking his cats, which started him on the path of photographing nature. This love for nature later translated into his volunteering at an exhibition of snakes for the Bombay Natural History



SPORTS ▼

PADDLE TIME

The new guard of Indian table tennis is making its presence felt

It was the pre-quarterfinal at the WTT Star Contender Chennai in March and instead of celebrating his win Snehit Suravajjula simply stepped aside after the match. It was a moment to cherish for his defeated opponent, celebrated Indian paddler Achanta Sharath Kamal, as he called time on his glorious two-decade-long career. When they later teamed up in the doubles to make the semi-final, it was symbolic of the past and present of Indian table tennis coming together for an encore. "It was an honour to play against him as well as partner him in his final tournament. I've grown up watching Sharath *anna*, trained with him and reached out to him with all kinds of questions," says Suravajjula.

The tournament marked a transition of sorts, the new guard making their presence felt. Suravajjula, who recently broke into the top 100 of the world, reached the quarterfinal. India's highest ranked play-